



METROPOLITAN INTELLIGENCE

GREAT AFRICAN EXPLORATION GALA ANNOUNCED

From our own Reporter
London, June 22

The Exploratory Society of North Africa and the Society of South Equatorial Studies of Africa are to hold a museum gala next week, bringing together travellers, geographers, natural philosophers, and students of the African continent. The gathering is expected to be among the more notable scientific and diplomatic occasions of the present season.

Invitations are understood to have been extended to dignitaries representing the United States, Spain, Italy, Brazil, the Russian Empire, Ethiopia, the Ottoman Empire, and Austria-Hungary. Explorers lately returned from abroad are likewise expected to mingle with British experts and members of the learned societies.

Arrangements remain in progress, and further particulars respecting lectures, exhibits, and objects brought from recent expeditions are expected before the opening. The Chronicle shall report the proceedings as they become public.

POLICE INTELLIGENCE

GRISLY DISCOVERY UPON THE NECROPOLIS LINE

From our own Reporter

The remains of Mr. Horace DeWitt, whose disappearance from Whitecastle was reported in these columns, have been discovered in a shocking condition upon the London Necropolis Railway. The body, or portions thereof, were found by railway servants during the early hours, and the place was immediately secured pending the arrival of the Metropolitan Police.

Particular attention has been drawn

to a waxen cylinder found amid the remains. The object is now in police possession. Officials decline to state whether it resembles the curious sound-recording articles lately connected with disturbances elsewhere in the Metropolis, and no conclusion as to its significance has been made public.

The circumstances of Mr. DeWitt's death remain under inquiry. Police have requested that persons who saw him during the evening of his disappearance, particularly in or near Whitecastle, communicate with the nearest station-house. The Chronicle understands that several statements have already been taken.

MISSING YOUNG WOMAN — APPEAL FOR INFORMATION

Miss Dolly Preston has been reported missing after failing to return home from her employment at a florist's establishment. She was last seen leaving the shop near the close of the working day. Her family, greatly distressed, asks that any person possessing knowledge of her movements or present whereabouts communicate without delay with local law enforcement.

CITY INTELLIGENCE

THE WEATHER AND THE THAMES

From our own Reporter

The recent spell of warm and unsettled weather has again directed attention to conditions along the river and in the more crowded quarters of the Metropolis. Bargemen report variable visibility during the early hours, while householders in several low-lying streets complain of the familiar summer odours.

Municipal officers maintain that cleansing and drainage works are proceeding according to schedule. Traders near the river nevertheless urge greater haste, observing that the approach of the busiest portion of the season brings increased traffic to

streets already burdened by repairs.

No interruption of consequence to river commerce is reported, though masters of smaller craft have been advised to exercise particular care where morning haze obscures signals and mechanical traffic.

COURT AND SOCIETY

THE SEASON CONTINUES

From our Society Correspondent

The social season proceeds with its accustomed succession of dinners, musicales, charitable subscriptions, and private receptions. Scientific demonstrations continue to enjoy unusual favour among hosts wishing to provide their guests with something beyond the ordinary programme.

Conversation in several drawing-rooms has turned upon the increasingly public place occupied by electrical, mechanical, and arcane invention. Admirers speak of a new age of British ingenuity; more cautious voices wonder whether every experiment need be conducted quite so near the carpets.

Several charitable garden parties are announced for the coming week, with subscriptions expected to benefit hospitals and relief societies in the eastern districts. The attendance of a number of well-known patrons has already been signified, though the usual uncertainty of the English weather remains the chief subject of practical concern.

COMMERCIAL REPORT

RAILWAY AND ENGINEERING INTERESTS

From our City Correspondent

Railway securities remain the subject of steady attention, with particular notice paid to companies whose metropolitan interests depend upon improved signalling and mechanical regulation. Engineering concerns

associated with municipal works likewise continue to attract cautious investment.

Shipping and insurance houses report a generally steady week, although higher coal charges and delays at several wharves have occasioned some complaint among smaller carriers. No broad disturbance of commercial confidence is at present observed.

Manufacturers of electrical apparatus report continued demand from universities, laboratories, and municipal contractors. Insurers, for their part, are said to be examining with increasing care the language of policies covering experimental machinery and arcane apparatus.

GENERAL NOTICES

RAILWAY NOTICE

Passengers are advised that minor alterations to evening suburban services will take effect this Saturday owing to permanent-way works. Travellers should consult the revised boards posted at the principal stations.

LOST PROPERTY

A black silk parasol with a silver-mounted handle was left in a hansom cab between Bloomsbury and the Strand on Tuesday evening. The finder is requested to leave particulars with the Chronicle office.

AUCTION

Household furniture, books, plate, and miscellaneous effects from a residence near Russell Square will be sold by auction on Monday next at eleven o'clock. Catalogues may be had upon application.

LECTURE

Public lecture this Saturday: "The Modern Metropolis and Its Mechanical Future." Admission by subscription; doors at seven evening.